

not because of morality, values and ethics. It is simply because the fundamental faculties in their own body, mind, emotions and energies do not take instructions from them. They are reacting only to external situations.

Leadership demands extensive travel, handling of complex situations and diverse people from diverse backgrounds and cultures. When a human being, who has to continuously handle complex situations, is not spiritually established he will get pulled down. The work is not difficult but we do not know how to manage the systems. Systems can be managed from within if only you have access to what is the source of the body. Spirituality means gaining access to that dimension within you which is the very source of who you are. This is not about looking out, looking down, looking around. This is about looking inward.

Right now we are trying to handle the well-being of mankind, societies and nations in a very ad hoc way. When we create well-being by chance we are not taking charge of who we are. We are not taking charge of the basic source of creation within ourselves; we have lost access to that.

The journey from poverty to prosperity is a hard journey—whether it's for an individual, society or a nation. After making that journey people still do not know well-being. We are on the threshold of an economic prosperity, where we have the capability for the first time in many generations to

move a large mass of people from one level of living to another. I really fear that the way we are handling many things we may goof it up or we may postpone it to the next generation rather than making it happen now. The leadership of the next 10 years will decide what we will do with this. A leadership which is bereft of any spiritual content, of perception beyond the limitations of logical intellect cannot manage a situation like this with absolute clarity. It will manage by chance and can fail anytime.

No other land, no other culture, has seen as much work towards human consciousness that Indian culture has. The best acknowledgement of this came from Mark Twain, one of the greatest intellects of the last century, when he said, "Any thing that can ever be done either by man or God has been done in this land."

"Leadership needs spiritual intelligence"

DANAH ZOHAR THOUGHT LEADER, PHYSICIST, PHILOSOPHER AND AUTHOR

In the last century we broke the sound barrier, the challenge of this century is to break the thought barrier. It is thought that makes the world, thought that traps us in a cage, and thought that makes us fall so far below our potential as human beings. We need to change the way we think.

Once in Calcutta I saw an infant, some seven months old, naked, dirty, crawling alone on the streets. It disturbed me very deeply. When I mentioned this incident to a professor in Calcutta and asked him how he could talk about holiness and spirituality when a child is living on the streets like this, he said, "Oh, it is his fault. In India we believe that people are the subjects of their past lives, of their karma. This child was a bad man in his past life. So, he does not deserve your pity. If he does well in this life he will have a better life next time." That kind of fatalism is largely responsible for some of the problems that this country confronts.

The Economist says that modern India and its leadership are facing two huge problems. The first one is poverty. Eighty per cent of Indians live in extreme poverty. The second one is corruption—corruption that undermines the rule of law, which takes money out of the pockets of the people, which robs the state's infrastructure and wealth, which hinders respect for each other and for higher values.

According to Carl Jung, one of the greatest psychologists in the last 50 years, if things go wrong in the world it is because something is wrong with yourself, something is wrong with the individual. You are not the victim of history or circumstances. You create history, you are responsible for it. This call to give up the victim word is not spirituality. It is spiritual intelligence. It is spiritual intelligence that leadership needs more than spirituality or religion.

Let me define the 12 principles of spiritual intelligence. The first is self awareness. I am someone empowered by my



(From left) Vasudev, session chairperson Javed Akhtar and Zohar